



EAGLE MOUNTAIN CITY COUNCIL MEETING – SPECIAL SESSION MINUTES

AUGUST 6, 6:00 PM
EAGLE MOUNTAIN CITY COUNCIL CHAMBERS
1650 E STAGECOACH RUN, EAGLE MOUNTAIN, UT 84005

ELECTED OFFICIALS PRESENT: Councilmembers Craig Whiting, Melissa Clark, Rich Wood, Brett Wright and Zachory Huish.

ELECTED OFFICIALS PRESENT ELECTRONICALLY: Mayor Jared R. Gray.

CITY STAFF PRESENT: Benjamin Reeves, City Manager; Steve Mumford, Deputy City Manager; Carson Stapley, Information Systems Manager; Evan Berrett, Director of Legislative and Strategic Services; Marcus Draper, City Attorney; Lacie Messerly, City Recorder; Kimberly Ruesch, Director of Administrative Services; Kyle Ireland, Communications Manager; Natalie Winterton, Assistant to the City Manager; Stephanie Allred, Deputy Recorder; Penny Vigil, Deputy Recorder; David Ulibarri, Public Safety Director; and Uth County Sheriff Mike Smith.

7:00 PM CITY COUNCIL – SPECIAL SESSION

1. CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Gray called the meeting to order at 6:02 PM.

[The recording of the discussion can be found online here at 00:04:38.](#)

2. PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Councilmember Whiting led the Pledge of Allegiance.

3. PUBLIC HEARING: PROPOSED TAX INCREASE (TRUTH-IN-TAXATION)

3.A. PUBLIC HEARING ONLY – Proposed Property Tax Increase

Mayor Gray provided information regarding the packets available to those in the audience, which included an agenda, the Utah County Notice of Proposed Tax Increase, the Proposed Property Tax Impact Schedule, and Information regarding Eagle Mountain City property tax basics. Mayor Gray also reviewed the rules and procedures for the public hearing.

Mayor Gray opened the public comment period at 6:07 PM.

The following individuals provided public comment regarding the proposed tax increase: John Breeding, Melissa Bradley, Adam Bradley (whose comment was read by his wife, Melissa Bradley), Duncan Searcy, Charles Peterson, Dave Bresnahan, Bryan Free, Matthew Endicott, Andrew Burke, Kelly Horton, Anthony Wood, Bruno Hunziker, Nathan Thornburg, Matt Everett, Mark McConkie, Betty Peralta, Joseph Petillot, Josh Schadt, Mark Espinoza, Jeff Ruth, Denver Dorrall, Mark Cookson, Traci Porretta, Steve Porretta, Charlotte Ducos, Michael Valentini, Elba Maria Perez, Walter Peterson, Jacob Moore, Jason Rasmussen, Joy Rasmussen, Michael Carey, Camille Gardner, KB Bergeson, Steve Campbell, Cedric De Chermont, Daniel Laub, Shana Clark, Kristen Meyer, Cheryl Karr, Roger Laird, Zeke Magdaleo, Megan Strader, Tony Castillo, Melanie Castillo, Matthew Joseph, JoAnna Brown, Chris Waldran, Eric Nelson, Elisa Harless, and James Russon.

The following individuals submitted comments by email or requested that their comments be read by City Recorder Lacie Messerly regarding the proposed tax increase: Garrett Haueter, Isaac Gardner, Dax Steidley, Colton Hart, Sadie Hart, Melissa Gordet, David Gordet, Jessica Demers, Alex Nelson, Briana Nelson, M. Patrick Mayo, Derek Rappleye, Trenton Webb, Briti Mitchell, Liliana Elliot, Kami Watterson, Jill Jones, Suzanna Norris, Brenda Martinez, Zachary Vance, Martin Indreboe, David Salazar, Gary Fewkes, Steve Proffit, Vienna Porretta, and Ethan Neal.

The following individuals provided virtual public comment regarding the proposed tax increase: Alex Washburn, Ben Crabtree, Cam Pew, Carli King, Steve Mugleston, Joel Anderson, Joe Richmond, Zachary Vance, Tim Blair, Roxanne Richmond, and Tyler Duchos.

After all individuals who wished to speak had been given an opportunity to comment, *Mayor Gray closed the public comment period at 9:00 PM*

The public hearing was held to receive public comment regarding the proposed tax increase. Individuals speaking during the hearing expressed both support for and opposition to the proposed increase. Comments included concerns regarding the financial impact on property owners and residents, the necessity and intended use of the additional revenue, municipal services and infrastructure needs, and other matters related to the proposed tax increase.

[The recording of the discussion can be found online here at 00:07:07.](#)

4. RESOLUTIONS

- 4.A. RESOLUTION – A Resolution of Eagle Mountain City, Utah, Approving a Property Tax Increase above the Certified Tax Rate for Fiscal Year 20226-2027.

Mayor Gray read the Proposed Property Tax Impact Schedule.

The City Council discussed the proposed property tax increase, including concerns raised by citizens, the reason for the proposed increase and the use of additional funds.

[The recording of the discussion can be found online here at 03:32:53.](#)

MOTION: *Councilmember Whiting moved to adopt a Resolution of Eagle Mountain City, Utah, to approve and adopt a property tax rate of 0.001500 for Fiscal Year 2026-2027. This rate exceeds the certified tax rate of 0.000530 and will result in an increase in the City's ad valorem property tax budgeted revenue of approximately \$5,591,594.00 or 183.02% above the City's property tax budgeted revenue for the prior year, exclusive of new growth. Councilmember Wright seconded the motion.*

Melissa Clark	Yes
Zachory Huish	Yes
Craig Whiting	Yes
Rich Wood	Yes
Brett Wright	Yes

The motion passed with a unanimous vote.

[The recording of the motion can be found online here at 04:37:27.](#)

5. ADJOURNMENT

MOTION: *Councilmember Wood moved to adjourn the meeting at 10:38 PM. Councilmember Wright seconded the motion.*

Melissa Clark	Yes
Zachory Huish	Yes
Craig Whiting	Yes
Rich Wood	Yes
Brett Wright	Yes

The motion passed with a unanimous vote.

[The recording of the motion can be found online here at 04:40:07.](#)

The meeting was adjourned at 10:38 PM.

Approved by the City Council on August 18, 2026.

Lacie A. Messerly
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City Recorder

